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BIT501 Business Concepts and Communication

Assessment 1

Weighting

30%

Learning outcomes

- 1 Describe business concepts in relation to organisational functions, structures and bi-cultural/multicultural contexts.
- 2 Evaluate the impact and role IT plays within an organisation in relation to supporting end users and meeting security, ethical and legal requirements.

Instructions

Complete and submit your assessment according to the Open Polytechnic's [Assessments webpage](#). This includes information on academic integrity, formatting, word limits and referencing.

- Include your name, student number and the assessment number.
- Number your pages.

Submission

- Submit your assessment in one file.
- Submit your work through your iQualify course.
- Emailed assessments will not be accepted.
- You will receive an automated notice advising you of your successful submission.

By submitting your assessment, you confirm that it is your own original work.

Assessment overview

For this assessment, you are answering questions to gain an internship with **DGTTSC**, an Aotearoa New Zealand-based company that provides a number of IT consulting services.

The name **DGTTSC** is based on the initials of the company's three founders but is not an abbreviation. The services range from business analysis to technical support. You have been tasked with reading the following case study and addressing the key tasks as if you had been successfully hired to be an intern with **DGTTSC**.

You are not required to write a formal business report. However, you are expected to use clear headings for each task and use full sentences and paragraphs rather than bullet points.

Case study: Maia's gym

Maia is the sole owner of a gym that specialises in running small group fitness classes in a range of community centres and local parks. The business does not have a fixed location, so they are able to avoid many of the overheads that come with leasing a physical space. Over the past 3 years, she has gone from running all the classes herself to managing a team of 10 personal trainers who conduct the classes on a contract basis. The business currently has a basic website that allows clients to book their classes online and offers equipment for hire.

Maia wants to streamline and grow her business by creating a scalable model that will allow for many of the day-to-day operations to be automated using the appropriate systems and software. Alongside this, new staff will need to be brought on board to manage the key business functions and allow Maia time to focus on growing the business.

Her idea is to create a website and app where personal trainers can advertise and schedule their services and an online wellness hub that will allow clients access to nutrition advice and online workouts. She plans to reach new customers through social media and is interested in learning more about how she can best leverage this to increase her customer numbers.

She has approached **DGTTSC** for help, and as the assigned consultant, you are required to consider and advise her.

Task 1

Maia currently operates as a sole trader, but she is aware that this might not be the best way to go forward as the business continues to grow. Describe three relevant advantages of establishing a company over remaining a sole trader. Explain their impacts on Maia's business.

(Word count guideline: 150–200 words)

(10 marks)

Task 2

Maia has now established a company. She is starting the development of an app to support her business. Discuss how the app and related IT systems may impact the following three areas:

- a. Sales and marketing

(10 marks)

- b. Finance and accounting

(10 marks)

- c. Human resources management and operations management.

(10 marks)

(Total word count guideline: 450–600 words)

Task 3

- a. Maia is well aware that in order to deploy an app for her company, she will need support in a number of key areas.

For this task, you are to recommend three main types of support Maia will need and discuss how that support will be provided to the end users of the app.

(Word count guideline: 150–200 words)

(10 marks)

- b. As part of the app development, both DGTSC and Maia have a strong commitment to te Tiriti o Waitangi / the Treaty of Waitangi.

Maia is considering the use of te reo Māori as an option alongside English in the app, as well as appropriate Māori artwork by a local Māori artist.

Discuss which of the three Ps (Partnership, Protection, Participation) these ideas would fall under. Provide clear evidence to support your answer and any important factors Maia needs to consider.

(Word count guideline: 150–200 words)

(10 marks)

Task 4

For this task, Maia now wants guidance on specific IT systems and practices her company can use to meet a number of obligations such as legal, ethical and security obligations. Use the information in the following tasks to address those requirements.

If anything is not clear, please describe any assumptions you may need to make about Maia's company to explain your answer.

- a. Maia now sees that the company will likely be hiring or contracting a range of new kaimahi (staff) as her company expands.

Maia also realises she will either need her own HR system or that she can outsource hiring to a New Zealand-based company.

Provide Maia with an outline of two ethical issues that HR recruiters and HR systems can face as part of the hiring process.

(Word count guideline: 150–200 words)

(10 marks)

- b. Maia previously used a spreadsheet to do her accounting.

While this was simple and straightforward for her to use, Maia realises that as her company grows, more people will need access to her accounting information.

Maia wants an outline of two main data security features that an accounting information system can provide to address her growing company.

(Word count guideline: 150–200 words)

(10 marks)

- c. Maia is excited that her company is growing, as she is hiring more kaimahi and growing her customer base.

A challenge she may face relates to her potential legal obligations under the Companies Act 1993 regarding financial reporting.

Maia requires an outline of the two types of financial statements she may be required to prepare and the consequences of failing to comply with reporting requirements.

(Word count guideline: 150–200 words)

(10 marks)

- d. Maia is aware that her company can use two main organisational structures. You are required to recommend an organisational structure for Maia.

You will need to describe the recommended organisational structure and provide two relevant reasons to support that choice.

(Word count guideline: 150–200 words)

(10 marks)

Marking schedule

Task 1	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
Describe three relevant advantages of establishing a company over remaining a sole trader. Explain their impacts on Maia’s business.	Three or more relevant advantages of establishing a company over remaining a sole trader are correctly described in detail. The description includes detailed and relevant explanations of the impacts of the advantages on Maia’s business.	Three relevant advantages of establishing a company over remaining a sole trader are correctly described with all key information included. The description includes relevant explanations of the impact of the advantages on Maia’s business.	Three advantages of establishing a company over remaining a sole trader are described. Most of the key information is included but with one or two minor omissions or inaccuracies. The description includes relevant explanations of the impact of the advantages on Maia’s business but lacks depth.	Attempts to describe three advantages of establishing a company over remaining a sole trader but with many mistakes. The description may include brief and vague explanations of the impact of the advantages on Maia’s business.	Attempts to list advantages, but they are poorly defined or not relevant. No or poor explanations of the impact of the advantages on Maia’s business are provided.
Task 2	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
Discuss how the app may impact the following three areas of Maia’s company: a. Sales and marketing b. Finance and accounting c. Human resources management and operations management.	Thoroughly and correctly describes both the impact and the role that the app plays in the areas of sales and marketing. Specific and relevant examples have been used to support the arguments.	Correctly describes both the impact and the role that the app plays in the areas of sales and marketing with all key information included. Relevant examples have been used to support the arguments.	Adequately describes both the impact and the role that the app plays in the areas of sales and marketing with most of the key information included but with one or two minor omissions or inaccuracies. Relevant but brief examples have been used to support the arguments.	Attempts to describe both the impact and the role that the app plays in the areas of sales and marketing but with many mistakes. Vaguely relevant examples are used to support the arguments.	Attempts to complete the task, but the impact and the role are poorly or incorrectly described. Examples are not relevant or not used at all.
	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
	Thoroughly and correctly describes both the impact and the role that the app	Correctly describes both the impact and the role that the app plays in the	Adequately describes both the impact and the role that the app plays in	Attempts to describes both the impact and the role that the app plays in	Attempts to complete the task, but the impact and

	plays in the areas of finance and accounting. Specific and relevant examples have been used to support the arguments.	areas of finance and accounting with all key information included. Relevant examples have been used to support the arguments.	the areas of finance and accounting with most of key information included, but with one or two minor omissions or inaccuracies. Relevant but brief examples have been used to support the arguments.	the areas of finance and accounting but with many mistakes. Vaguely relevant examples are used to support the arguments.	the role are poorly or incorrectly described. Examples are not relevant or not used at all.
	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
	Thoroughly and correctly describes both the impact and the role that the app plays in the areas of human resources management and operations management. Specific and relevant examples have been used to support the arguments.	Correctly describes both the impact and the role that the app plays in the areas of human resources management and operations management with all key information included. Relevant examples have been used to support the arguments.	Adequately describes both the impact and the role that the app plays in the areas of human resources management and operations management with most of the key information included, but with one or two minor omissions or inaccuracies. Relevant but brief examples have been used to support the arguments.	Attempts to describe both the impact and the role that the app plays in the areas of human resources management and operations management but with many mistakes. Vaguely relevant examples are used to support the arguments.	Attempts to complete the task, but the impact and the role are poorly or incorrectly described. Examples are not relevant or not used at all.
Task 3	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
a. For this task, you are to recommend three main types of support Maia will need and discuss how that support will be provided to the end users.	Three or more relevant types of support needed by Maia's company and how they are provided are correctly described in detail. The discussion includes detailed and relevant explanations of the	Three relevant types of support needed by Maia's company and how they are provided are correctly described with all key information included. The discussion includes relevant explanations of	Three relevant types of support needed by Maia's business and how they are provided are adequately described. Most of the key information is included but with one or two minor omissions or inaccuracies.	Attempts to describe three relevant types of support needed by Maia's business and how they are provided but with many mistakes. The discussion includes very brief explanations of	Attempts to list three relevant types of support, but they are poorly or incorrectly described. The discussion includes no or poor explanations of the support and how they are provided.
b. Maia is considering the use of te reo Māori as an					

option alongside English in the app, as well as appropriate Māori artwork by a local Māori artist. Discuss which of the three Ps these ideas would fall under with clear evidence to support your answer and any important factors Maia needs to consider.	support and how they are provided.	the support and how they are provided.	The discussion includes relevant explanations of the support and how they are provided but lacks depth.	the support and how they are provided.	
	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
	A thorough and structural discussion about which of the three Ps these ideas would fall under is provided. Clear and relevant evidence to support the arguments and detailed considerations Maia needs to take are explicitly included in the discussion.	A structural discussion about which of the three Ps these ideas would fall under is provided with all key information included. Relevant evidence to support the arguments and considerations Maia needs to take are included in the discussion.	An adequate discussion about which of the three Ps these ideas would fall under is provided. Most of the key information is included but with one or two minor omissions. Relevant evidence to support the arguments and brief considerations Maia needs to take are mentioned in the discussion.	A brief and vague discussion about which of the three Ps these ideas would fall under is provided. Remotely relevant evidence to support the arguments and vague considerations Maia needs to take are implied in the discussion.	Poor or irrelevant discussion about which of the three Ps these ideas would fall under is provided. Irrelevant or none of the evidence and considerations are implied in the discussion.
Task 4	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
a. Provide Maia with an outline of two ethical issues that HR recruiters and HR systems can both face as part of the hiring process. b. Provide an outline of two main data security features that an accounting information system can provide to her that address her growing company.	An accurate and structural outline of two ethical issues that HR recruiters and HR systems can both face as part of the hiring process is provided.	An accurate outline of two ethical issues that HR recruiters and HR systems can both face as part of the hiring process is provided with all key information included.	An adequate outline of two ethical issues that HR recruiters and HR systems can both face as part of the hiring process is provided. Most of the key information is included but with one or two minor omissions or inaccuracies.	An outline of two ethical issues that HR recruiters and HR systems can both face as part of the hiring process is provided with many mistakes.	A poor, inaccurate or no outline of two ethical issues that HR recruiters and HR systems can both face as part of the hiring process is provided.
	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
	An accurate and structural outline of two main data security features, which an accounting information	An accurate outline of two main data security features, which an accounting information system can provide to	An adequate outline of two main data security features, which an accounting information system can provide to	An outline of two main data security features, which an accounting information system can provide to address Maia's	A poor, inaccurate or no outline of two main data security features, which an accounting information system can

c. Provide an outline of the two types of financial statements she may be required to prepare and the consequences of failing to comply with reporting requirements. d. Recommend an organisational structure for Maia. Describe the recommended organisational structure and provide two relevant reasons to support that choice.	system can provide to address Maia's needs, is provided.	address Maia's needs, is provided with all key information included.	address Maia's needs, is provided. Most of key information is included but with one or two minor omissions or inaccuracies.	needs, is provided with many mistakes.	provide to address Maia's needs, is provided.
	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
	An accurate and structural outline of the two types of financial statements Maia may be required to prepare and the consequences of failing to comply are provided.	An accurate outline of the two types of financial statements Maia may be required to prepare and the consequences of failing to comply are provided with all key information included.	An adequate outline of the two types of financial statements Maia may be required to prepare and the consequences of failing to comply are provided. Most of key information is included but with one or two minor omissions or inaccuracies.	An outline of the two types of financial statements Maia may be required to prepare and the consequences of failing to comply are provided with many mistakes.	A poor, inaccurate or no outline of the two types of financial statements Maia may be required to prepare and the consequences of failing to comply are provided.
	8–10 marks	6.5–7.5 marks	5–6 marks	4–4.5 marks	1–3.5 marks
	A thorough and structural recommendation of the organisation structure for the company is provided. The recommended structure is accurately and structurally described in detail; the two reasons to support the choice are fully explained.	A structural recommendation of the organisation structure for the company is provided with all key information included. The recommended structure is accurately described; the two reasons to support the choice are clearly explained.	An adequate recommendation of the organisation structure for the company is provided. Most of key information is included but with one or two minor omissions. The recommended structure is adequately described; the two reasons to support the choice are explained but with one or two omissions.	A very brief recommendation of the organisation structure for the company is provided with many mistakes. The recommended structure is vaguely described; the two reasons to support the choice are explained with many omissions.	A very or no poor recommendation of the organisation structure for the company is provided. The recommended structure is not described or very poorly described; fewer than two reasons to support the choice are explained with many omissions.